

SWING REPAIR KIT (+ OF 4)

FROM DIGGING DEEPER JAZZ VIDEO #27

We need to be aware of, and comfortable with, syncopations (simply defined as "off beats"). This is especially true on the "+ of 4" going into the next chord change. This is a great tool that helps give us that "jazz syncopation" feel that is so central to jazz and swing music.

Seasoned pianists and guitarists, when comping jazz, will do just this - *they will play the next chord early*, typically on the "+ of 4" much of the time. This is standard practice. Drummers do something similar with their ride pattern, pushing into the next measure, on the "+ of 4."

Great melodies and jazz solos also use this tool. This is one of the reasons great bands sound great. There is an "unspoken" spot where everything magically lines up sometimes (piano, guitar, drums, melody, bass). A rhythmic place where the band might mysteriously "hit exactly together." That unspoken place is the "+ of 4," and it is often going into the next chord change.

The etude here uses this syncopation a total of 14 times, coming into every single change of chord. I actually used it on the "+ of 2" in the last two measures as well, into those faster moving chords.

Notice the accents I put in above every syncopation. In these spots, we want to really "place the note." Not only is it syncopated, but it is 1) played a bit louder, 2) played a bit more percussively, and 3) played with a slight different timbre on the instrument (all of which are the result of digging in a little harder on that note).

Bb Instruments



C Instruments

Chord progression for C Instruments:

- Staff 1: F7, Bb7, F7, F7
- Staff 2: Bb7, Bb7, F7, D7(b9)
- Staff 3: Gm7, C7, F7, D7, Gm7, C7

Eb Instruments

Chord progression for Eb Instruments:

- Staff 1: D7, G7, D7, D7
- Staff 2: G7, G7, D7, B7(b9)
- Staff 3: Em7, A7, D7, B7, Em7, A7

Bass Clef Instruments

Chord progression for Bass Clef Instruments:

- Staff 1: F7, Bb7, F7, F7
- Staff 2: Bb7, Bb7, F7, D7(b9)
- Staff 3: Gm7, C7, F7, D7, Gm7, C7